**Q MongoDB had an official launch in India very recently. Could you elaborate on the company's activities in India right now?**

We started our operations in India just a couple of months back. Before that, we were established in Singapore, which was our headquarters for Asia Pacific. We have had quite a large presence in Asia, where we have primarily focused on global support for our customers. In essence, our presence in Asia was just around support. We never focused on growing a community or a commercial model. So that is what we thought we should be focusing on now and obviously, India being a very important market for us, we decided to have a physical presence in the country.

**Q In what sense is India important for you and what sectors are you looking at to expand your footprint in the country?**

If you look at some of the applications being used in India and the sheer volume of data they involve, it is massive. If you look at any of the industries, whether it is telecom applications and systems, financial services, and even some of the largest core banking solutions, they are in India. So in that context, we are probably a very good fit to address the large Big Data challenges that we foresee our customers facing in the coming years. In India, the sheer volume of the population poses a lot of challenges in unique ways, and I think that is where open source and MongoDB provide a tremendous opportunity for the market. We have a large user community in India. I think about 1800 user members are currently with MongoDB in India and this number is growing aggressively. We see a tremendous uptake of the technology through the open source community and also through customers actively looking at enterprise-based solutions, which can help them address their data growth needs.

**Q You are also expanding in terms of headcount. So, what kind of hiring are you looking at for the Indian office that you have set up?**

As I mentioned, we have support infrastructure in place already. We plan to expand that in the coming months, and that expansion should happen probably in various parts of Asia and not just India. The other area where we are heavily focused on is increasing our presence in not just India and China, but also in Japan and South East Asia. We are looking at hiring candidates who can help build the community efforts for us, and also help us build relationships with our enterprise customers.

**Q Are you also planning to hire some developers in India?**

Our development is currently happening in New York and in Palo Alto, which is our headquarters for engineering. As of now, I am not aware of any plans of software development in India. However, if you look at our investment in R&D, which is aggressively ramping up with our new kinds of funding, the scenario could change. But there are no immediate plans of any investments in R&D in India.

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**Q Developers are now shifting from the established databases to the NoSQL databases. What do you think are the reasons for this increasing interest?**

If you look at some of the legacy relational databases, they have their inherent challenges of being data technologies to an extent. There are ways of developing applications, and developers are looking at different models of trying to address the different interface solutions. In many of the cases, they have to use legacy relational datastores and legacy architectures. And the shift among developers is to address these new challenges. The data that we are storing today is very different from the data that we stored in the past 10-15 years. That is really what is driving developers to look at datastores, and this is where we see the significant shift in the industry. If you look at MongoDB, we are a document-oriented database that effectively allows us to be a general-purpose database. We are not focused on niche solution areas, but we are very focused on providing an alternative to a strict relational datastore—something that we feel is dynamically scaling towards the Big Data solution for customers today.

Customers want agile data frameworks today and to do that, you need to move away from the legacy relational models, which are mathematically quite advanced. You do have some constraints that you need to make to your data but, ideally, you need agile capabilities built into the framework. That is where developers are actively looking at options on how to address and how to store the data today in different stores versus what they have done in the past. And that is where I think the shift has happened. It would be fair to say that a lot of applications in relational datastores are based on existing core applications, which require